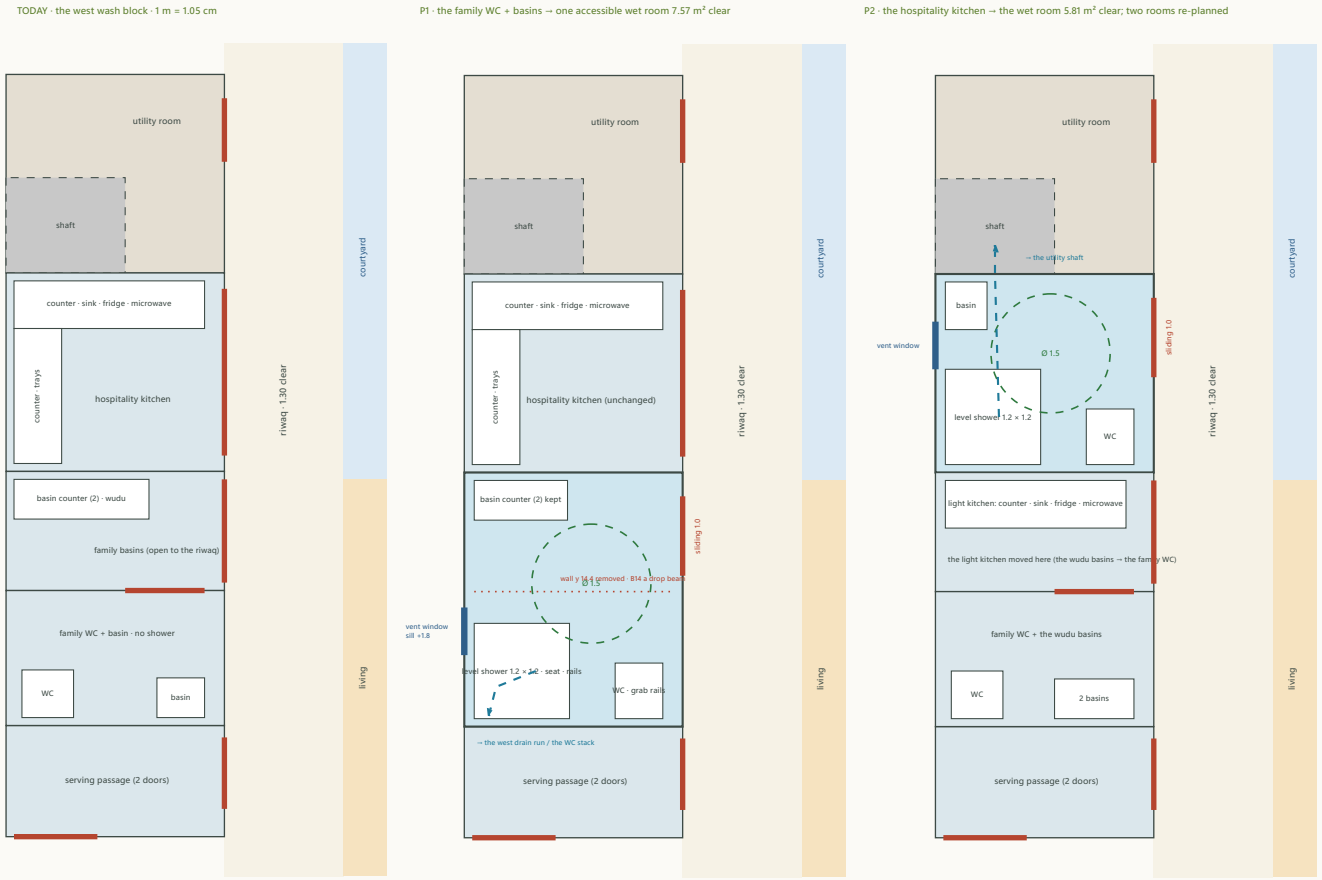
A ground-floor shower · design review G-07, ageing in place · three positions compared · Taif / Palm House V8.1 · STUDY ONLY

2 Nov 2026 · today the ground floor has the family WC, the guest WC and the maid bath (the only shower, the maid's) · a level walk-in shower ≥ 0.9 × 1.2 m, a 1.5 m turning circle where possible, access from the family side, a drain to a stack, ventilation, privacy · nothing in the design files changes until the owner decides · all sizes assumed



P1 · the family WC and the family basins become one accessible wet room (recommended)

- **Where:** the west wash block, x 0–2.75, y 12.9–16.1: the two rooms merged by removing the wall on y 14.4; **2.53 × 3 = 7.57 m² clear**.
- **Layout:** the **wudu basin counter kept** on the north wall (two basins, 1.2 m); a **level walk-in shower 1.2 × 1.2** at the south-west corner (a fold-down seat, grab rails, a curtain or a half screen, the floor falling to its outlet: the ground slab is on grade, so the floor is lowered locally with no beam in the way); the **WC** at the south-east corner with grab rails both sides; a **1.5 m turning circle** in the middle (the level shower zone may be part of it); a **1.0 m sliding door** on the riwaq side (no swing in the 1.30 m riwaq), parking on the 1.9 m of wall south of it. Non-slip tiles, a hand shower, lever taps, a night light.
- **Access:** from the riwaq (the family side), 3 m from the lift, never through the guest side. **Drain:** the shower outlet into the west drain run under the wash block beside the existing WC stack (one run, as decided). **Ventilation:** a small west window (sill +1.8, under the first-floor bath 3's window) plus an extract fan. **Privacy:** its own door; the shower and the WC at the south end, out of the door's sight line; the basins by the door.
- **Effect on the rooms around:** the **open wudu basins** (open to the riwaq today) are now **behind a sliding door that stays open by day**: the one real loss; the hospitality kitchen, the serving passage, the utility room and the riwaq are untouched. **Structure:** the GF wall on y 14.4 carries the hidden beam **B14** under the first-floor wall between bedroom 2 and bath 3: without the wall, B14 becomes a **drop beam 0.25 × 0.45** spanning 2.75 m from the west wall to B10, hidden in the wet room's gypsum ceiling (the house rule): the engineer.

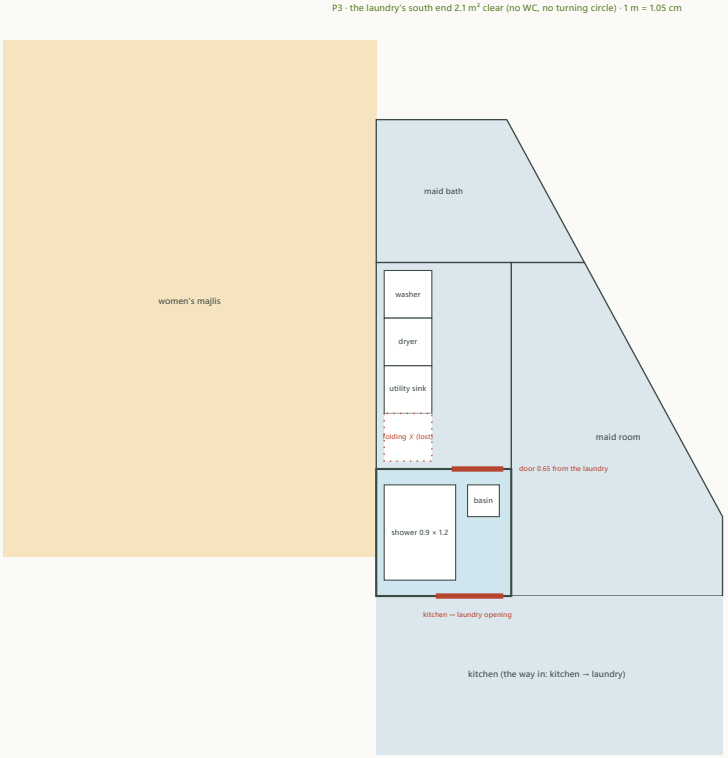
P2 · the hospitality kitchen becomes the wet room; the light kitchen moves

- **Where:** x 0–2.75, y 10.4–12.9: **5.81 m² clear**, the roomiest; the turning circle, the shower, a WC and a basin fit; the **utility shaft is next door** (the shortest drain, 1.5 m north); a west vent window; a sliding door on the riwaq.
- **But:** the hospitality kitchen (decision 5: the light kitchen beside the serving passage) must move into the basins' room (a 2.3 m counter, cramped), and the wudu basins then move into the family WC room: **three rooms re-planned**, the open wudu place lost all the same. No structural change (the walls y 10.4 and 12.9 stay).

P3 · the laundry's south end (maid wing)

- **Where:** x 8.95–10.65, y 5.4–7.0: **2.1 m² clear**: a shower 0.9 × 1.2 and a basin fit, **no WC, no turning circle**; the drain into the maid wing's east run (short). **But:** reached only **through the kitchen and the laundry** (the service side: wrong for a guest or an elderly parent, and in the maid's way); no window (the laundry is internal: mechanical vent only); the laundry loses its folding and drying space (2.6 m left for the washer, the dryer and the sink). Rejected.

P3 for the record · the comparison · recommendation · the decision needed



Comparison

Criterion	P1 · family WC + basins → wet room	P2 · hospitality kitchen → wet room	P3 · laundry's south end
Size, clear	7.57 m² (2.53 × 3.0)	5.81 m² (2.53 × 2.3)	2.1 m² (1.5 × 1.4)
Level shower ≥ 0.9 × 1.2 · turning circle	1.2 × 1.2 **OK** · Ø 1.5 **OK**	1.2 × 1.2 **OK** · Ø 1.5 **OK**	0.9 × 1.2 **OK** · none **NO**
WC and basin inside	WC + the two wudu basins	WC + basin	basin only **NO**
Access from the family side	the riwaq, 3 m from the lift **OK**	the riwaq, 1 m from the lift **OK**	kitchen → laundry (service side) **NO**
Drain to a stack	the west drain run / the WC stack, in place **OK**	the utility shaft, 1.5 m **OK**	the maid wing's east run **OK**
Ventilation	a west window + a fan	a west window + a fan	mechanical only **NO**
Privacy	own door; the wet end out of sight	own door	through the laundry **NO**
Rooms around	the open wudu basins go behind a door; the rest untouched	the hospitality kitchen and the wudu basins move: three rooms re-planned	the laundry loses its folding and drying space
Structure	B14 becomes a drop beam over the removed wall (the engineer)	none	none
Cost	one wet room re-fitted, a wall out, a beam, a window	a wet room + a kitchen moved + the WC room re-fitted	a small shower room, a partition

Recommendation: P1

- P1 gives a real accessible wet room (a level shower, a turning circle, a WC with rails, two basins) **on the family side, 3 m from the lift, on the existing drain run**, for one wall removed and one beam. Its cost is that the family's wudu basins stand behind a sliding door that is open by day. P2 does the same for three rooms re-planned; P3 is a service-side shower without a WC.
- **P1-lite (the fallback):** keep the basins' room as it is and re-fit only the family WC room (2.53 × 1.5 clear) as a **shower + WC** (a level shower 0.9 × 1.2 at the west end, the WC at the east end, no basin inside, no turning circle): an injured person can shower on the ground floor, a wheelchair cannot turn. No structure, no window, the basins stay open.
- **Conditions for P1:** the engineer confirms B14 as a drop beam (or a lintel) over the removed wall; the MEP engineer the floor drain's fall in the ground slab and the fan; a lever-handle sliding door; the wet room finished to the ageing-in-place list (seat, rails, non-slip floor, a night light).

Decision needed from the owner

1. **P1** (the family WC + basins as one accessible wet room; the basins behind a door by day, recommended), **P1-lite** (the family WC room only: shower + WC, no turning circle), or **P2** (the hospitality kitchen as the wet room, three rooms re-planned)?

Study checks passed (7)

Checks: P1: a level shower ≥ 0.9 × 1.2 (1.2 × 1.2) · P1: a 1.5 m turning circle clear of the basins and the WC (the level shower zone may be part of it) · P1: every fixture inside the clear room, none overlapping · P1: the door (1.0, sliding) on the riwaq side, parking on the wall south of it (1.9 m of wall) · P2: a 1.5 m turning circle and the shower ≥ 0.9 × 1.2 inside the clear room · P3: the shower ≥ 0.9 × 1.2 fits, but no turning circle (1.5 × 1.4 clear) and no WC: reported · P1 and P2 are entered from the riwaq (the family side), P3 only through the kitchen and the laundry (the service side). The family WC's fixtures today are assumed (they are not in the files). Nothing here changes the room CSVs, the design files or the structure; every size is assumed.